

Seungmin (Min) Lee

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Fields

Applied Microeconometrics, Development Economics, Agricultural Economics, Public Policy.

Education

Ph.D. Applied Economics and Management, Cornell University, 2024.

Concentration: Food & Agricultural Economics, Economic Development & Planning, Public Policy

Dissertation Title: [Essays on Food Security in the U.S.](#)

B.S. with Distinction, Mathematics and Economics (Double Major), University of Michigan in Ann Arbor, 2014.

Job Market Paper

"Estimating Long Run Welfare Outcome in Rotating Panel with Grouped Fixed Effects: Application to Poverty Dynamics in Peru." - with Hongdi Zhao, Aug 2026

This paper introduces an empirical method to estimate welfare dynamics using a rotating panel design. The paper employs the grouped fixed effects (GFE) estimator to exploit within-household variation from short-term observations and to estimate longer-term welfare and its dynamics using time-varying group-level heterogeneity, relaxing a few assumptions in the previous literature. The paper applied this method to Peru's National Household Survey on Living Conditions and Poverty (ENAHOP) from 2007 to 2019 and examined long-term poverty and its dynamics during this period. The new method estimates household-level poverty status and its transitions reasonably well, suggesting it as a new approach to studying household welfare dynamics at the group level and providing an interpretable grouping structure that supports richer descriptions of poverty persistence and mobility.

Presentations: International Conference on Empirical Economics (2026), Northeastern Universities Development Consortium (2026, expected), Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting (2026, expected)

Employment

University of Notre Dame, Pulte Institute for Global Development, Postdoctoral Research Associate, (2024 - Present)

Cornell University, Graduate Research Assistant (2019-2024)

World Bank, Development Impact Evaluation, Consultant (2016 - 2018)

Innovations for Poverty Action, Research Analyst (2015 - 2016)

Awards

Excellence in Research, Pulte Institute for Global Development, University of Notre Dame (2026)

George F. Warren Award (First Place), for the best graduate student research paper, Dyson School, Cornell University (2022)

Refereed Publications

Seungmin Lee, Kibrom A. Abay, Christopher B. Barrett, and John Hoddinott. 2026. "[Estimating Multidimensional Development Resilience](#)." *Journal of Development Economics* 178 (January): 103583. 10.1016/j.jdevco.2025.103583

Seungmin Lee, Christopher B. Barrett, John F. Hoddinott. 2024. "[Food Security Dynamics in the United States: 2001-2017](#)." *American Journal of Agricultural Economics* 1-24. 10.1111/ajae.12433

Blogs: [Cornell Chronicle](#)

Other Publications

Ndèye Fatou Faye, Amy Faye, Mouhammed Rassoul Sy, Seungmin Lee, John McPeak, "[Domestic or Imported: An Analysis of Rice Demand in Senegal](#)" January 2022. PRCI Policy Briefs 322052, Michigan State University, Department of Agricultural, Food and Resource Economics, Food Security Group.

Working Papers

Hogan-Hennessy, Senan, Seungmin Lee, Christopher B. Barrett, John F. Hoddinott, and Matthew P. Rabbitt. "[Food Insecurity Among Military Veterans](#)." Sep 2026. *under review*

Presentations: Panel Study of Income Dynamics User Conference (2026)

Seungmin Lee, John Hoddinott, Chris Barrett, and Matthew Rabbit, "[The Probability of Food Security: A new longitudinal data set using the Panel Study of Income Dynamics](#)." Sep 2025. *under review*

Presentations: (presented as part of "The Effects of the Food Stamp Program and SNAP on Food Security Dynamics, 1979-2019") USDA Economic Research Service (ERS), Brown Bag Seminar Series (invited) (2023), USDA/ERS - University of Nebraska Food Security Symposium (2023), AAEA Annual Meeting (2022), SEA Annual Meeting (2022), PSID User Conference (2022)

Seungmin Lee, "[How much does SNAP Matter? SNAP's Effects on Food Security](#)." Oct 2025.

Presentations: SEA Annual Meeting (2025)

Work in Progress

Does Compensating for Conservation have Long-Lasting Impacts? Evidence from Uganda and Bolivia - with Sacha Ortiz Siani, Krister Andersson, Lakshmi Iyer and Daniel C. Miller

Presentations: National Sustainability Society 2nd Annual Conference (2025), FLARE Annual Meeting (2025)

The Long-term Effects of Decentralization on Conservation Socioeconomic Well-being; Evidence from Bolivia and Peru - with Valentina Muñoz Bernal, Sacha Ortiz Siani, and Krister Andersson

Presentations: National Sustainability Society 3rd Annual Conference (2026)

Inequality, Participation, and the Design of Local Development Projects: Experimental Evidence - with Nathan Cook, Tara Grillos, and Krister Andersson

Unconditional Cash Transfers Targeting Rural Poverty Can Yield Ecological Co-Benefits - with Sacha Ortiz Siani, Krister Andersson, Lakshmi Iyer, Gordon Sigu Onduru, Moses Nyawasa, Daniel C. Miller

The Effects of REDD+ on Inequality - with Nathan Cook and Adriana Molina-Garzón

Invited Talks, Seminars and Conference Presentations

2026: [International Conference on Empirical Economics](#), Northeastern Universities Development Consortium (expected), Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting (expected), [National Sustainability Society 3rd Annual Conference](#), Panel Study of Income Dynamics User Conference.

2025: [National Sustainability Society 2nd Annual Conference](#), [FLARE Annual Meeting](#), [Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting](#)

2023: USDA ERS, [Agricultural and Applied Economics Association \(AAEA\) Annual Meeting](#), USDA/ERS - University of Nebraska Food Security Symposium

2022: [Agricultural and Applied Economics Association \(AAEA\) Annual Meeting](#), [The Panel Study of Income Dynamics Annual User Conference](#), [Southern Economic Association \(SEA\) 92nd Annual Meeting](#)

2021: [31st International Conference of Agricultural Economists](#), [Center for Poverty Research Workshop at the University of Kentucky](#)

Teaching

Cornell University

Teaching Assistant

Managerial Economics (AEM 2600) - Fall 2019 (Instructor: Benjamin Leyden)

International Trade and Finance (AEM 2300) - Spring 2020 (Instructor: David Lee)

Applied Econometrics (AEM 6120) - Fall 2022 (Instructor: Brian Dillon)

Master's Math Camp - Summer 2023

Professional Membership

American Economic Association, Agricultural and Applied Economics Association, Northeastern Agricultural and Resource Economics Association, Southern Economic Association, Midwest Economics Association

Services

Editorial Service

Referee for *Applied Economic Perspectives and Policy*, *Food Policy*, *Poverty & Public Policy*, *Frontiers in Climate*, *Frontiers in Public Health*, *Social Sciences & Humanities*, *Nutrition Reviews*

Reviewer for the Northeast Universities Development Consortium (NEUDC) Conference, 2026

University Service

Graduate Student Association, Cornell Dyson School (2021-2022)

Mentorship at Structural Transformation of African Agriculture and Rural Spaces (STAARS) Fellowship (2020 - 2021): *Mentored African scholars in conducting research.*

References

Chris Barrett

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Cornell University
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and Policy
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